

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Shares of Alphabet** rose and Nvidia's fell in a session that saw the S&P 500 and Nasdaq gain 0.9% and 0.7%, respectively. The Dow notched its best day since August, advancing 1.4%. **A1**
- ◆ **Powell allies laid** the groundwork for the Fed chair to push a rate cut through a divided committee at December's meeting. **A2**
- ◆ **Higher energy and food** costs lifted wholesale prices in September, the Labor Department said. **A2**
- ◆ **Meta Platforms is in** talks to use chips made by Google in its AI efforts, a step toward diversifying away from its reliance on Nvidia. **A2**
- ◆ **HP plans to cut up to** 10% of its workforce as it invests further in artificial intelligence, a move its chief executive sees as essential to maintaining its competitive edge. **B1**
- ◆ **Campbell's said it placed** an executive on temporary leave after he was allegedly caught on tape saying the company made "highly processed" food for "poor people." **B3**
- ◆ **A federal judge endorsed** Elliott Investment Management's roughly \$6 billion bid for Venezuela's shares of Citgo Petroleum, pushing the forced sale of the country's prized foreign asset closer to completion. **B1**
- ◆ **Walmart is testing** ads in its new AI shopping agent, Sparky, in an effort that could lead to the monetization of chat experiences. **B1**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Ukraine told the Trump** administration it would sign a U.S.-drafted peace deal to end the war with Russia, U.S. officials said, despite Washington and Kyiv signaling that diplomatic hurdles remain and Moscow weighing how to respond. **A1, A7**
- ◆ **The White House is** defending special envoy Steve Witkoff over a reportedly leaked conversation in which he told a Russian official that praising Trump would help smooth over a call with Putin regarding the war in Ukraine. **A7**
- ◆ **Speaker Mike Johnson** cautioned the White House that most House Republicans don't have an appetite for extending enhanced Affordable Care Act subsidies. **A4**
- ◆ **The U.S. government** negotiated lower prices in the federal Medicare program for 15 high-selling medicines including Ozempic. **A4**
- ◆ **A group of Democratic** lawmakers said the FBI requested interviews with them after they appeared in a video that criticized the Trump administration and called on troops to disobey unlawful orders. **A5**
- ◆ **Washington, D.C., Mayor** Muriel Bowser said she would leave her office when her current term expires. **A5**
- ◆ **The U.S. Navy plans** to cancel orders for four new warships after the government's extensive design modifications set back construction by years. **A5**

NOTICE TO READERS

WSJ.com and WSJ mobile apps will publish throughout the Thanksgiving holiday. The print edition won't appear on Thursday.

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In Holiday Rush, Not All Items Go in Overhead Bin



ARE WE THERE YET? Travelers walked to a security checkpoint at Reagan National Airport outside Washington on Tuesday, getting a head start on the holiday. The government is preparing for the busiest Thanksgiving week for air travel in 15 years.

As Small Investors Crave Risk, Robinhood Amps Up Offerings

Aggressive traders fuel firm's success, but critics liken the platform to a casino

By HANNAH ERIN LANG

The chief executive of Robinhood Markets took the stage at the online brokerage's annual summit in Las Vegas this fall decked out in a race-car driver's jumpsuit and customized Nikes.

Vlad Tenev told the hundreds of cheering traders in the audience that they had chosen "one of the most intense lifestyles out there." He

compared trading to driving a race car. "A finely tuned machine can make all the difference," he said, "and that's the role we feel Robinhood plays for our active investors."

Risk-taking is back for individual investors, and few people have done more to stoke those spirits than the 38-year-old Tenev. Robinhood's trading app makes it easy not just to buy and sell ordinary stocks, but to invest in options, cryptocurrencies and other exotic financial products, even to make sports bets and play the prediction markets.

The company's critics liken the environment to a casino, but its fans credit Robinhood

with democratizing the lucrative world of sophisticated investments.

"He's almost building a cult," said Aaron Cook, a 28-year-old plumber who was in the audience in Las Vegas. Cook said he had used his profits from trading stocks, options and memecoins to buy a Jeep Wrangler and a \$60,000 home.

A host of new products have entered retail-investment markets in recent years and worked their way into the mainstream. Investors are wagering on crypto and piling into ultrarisky options contracts. They are buying futures contracts tied to all

sorts of events, betting on whether a Taylor Swift album will top the Spotify charts or whether the Green Bay Packers will beat the Detroit Lions on Thanksgiving Day.

Robinhood has been at the forefront of making such products available to ordinary investors.

Abishek Gopal, 35, said he wakes up at 6:30 a.m. to start trading some of the riskiest forms of options, including the "zero day" variety that quickly expire and require perfect timing. It's a hobby he said he never would have picked up if not for how easy it is on Robinhood. "The thrill gets me go-

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Cars? Gucci? Amazon Bets on Pricey Goods

By SEAN MCLAIN

Steve Picciotti's Amazon.com purchases in April included an \$8 USB cable, a \$90 beard trimmer and a \$45,000 Hyundai Santa Fe SUV.

Picciotti is the sort of die-hard customer the company is banking on to prove that people are finally ready to buy cars and Chanel handbags from the same place they get toilet paper and generic batteries.

Amazon tried for nearly a decade to convince brands to list their big-ticket items on its website, with mixed results.

Many balked, saying at the time they didn't want their products to sit alongside knockoffs, or toothpaste.

While convincing companies to work with Amazon was slow, this year's Black Friday shoppers will be able to browse Saks Fifth Avenue's shoe department, as well as Hermès Birkins and Rolex watches from luxury reseller Rebag. Last week, Ford announced that its dealers would offer used cars for sale on Amazon, joining Hyundai and rental car company Hertz.

The question is no longer: *Please turn to page A4*

Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade Magic Trick: Disappearing

Volunteers train at 'flight schools' to learn to deflate balloons in minutes. Don't inhale.

By AMIRA MCKEE

For the millions of Americans tuning in from their living rooms, the Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade ends with a familiar crescendo: the roar of the crowds, a blizzard of confetti, and a final wave from Santa Claus.

But for Kathy Kramer, who has handled the parade's colossal balloons for decades, work's not over.

In a ritual unseen by the cameras, volunteers heave the floating icons toward the asphalt. They yank open industrial-grade zippers, unleashing a gust of helium, and dive chest-first onto the collapsing

character. The goal is to undo 90 minutes of inflation in just 15.

The urgency is real. Kramer warns that if the team doesn't deflate fast enough, the next balloon in the lineup "will just walk right over the top of us."

"The parade keeps coming," said Kramer, a Macy's employee who will pilot this year's Diary of a Wimpy Kid balloon. "When you get to the bottom of an escalator, if you stop there and stand and look around, everybody's coming down behind you. So you got to keep moving."

Call it the parade's final magic trick: making hundreds *Please turn to page A10*

INSIDE



SPORTS

Lane Kiffin is about to become college football's highest-paid coach yet. **A12**

U.S.'s Ukraine Plan Had Kremlin Input

WASHINGTON—It started with an October order from President Trump to his national-security team: Come up with a plan to end the Ukraine war just as they had halted the fighting in Gaza.

By Robbie Gramer, Alexander Ward and Lara Seligman

On a flight back from the Middle East, after brokering a deal between Israel and Hamas, envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner began writing the first draft of what would eventually become a

28-point peace framework to end the four-year war, U.S. officials and a person familiar with the situation said.

Ukraine told the Trump administration on Tuesday it would sign the U.S.-drafted deal to end the war with Russia, U.S. officials said, despite Washington and Kyiv signaling remaining diplomatic hurdles and Moscow weighing how to respond.

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◆ **Witkoff's talk with Putin** aide is scrutinized..... **A7**

◆ **Many Ukrainians oppose** giving up any territory... **A7**

Teens Bid Sad Goodbye To Their Chatbot Friends

By GEORGIA WELLS

When Olga López heard she would lose access to her collection of role-playing chatbots, she felt a surge of emotions: sadness, outrage, bewilderment.

Olga, who is 13 years old, turns to her chatbots from artificial-intelligence company Character.AI for romantic role playing when she doesn't have homework. Like the company's other under-18 customers, she was notified in October that she would no longer be able to have ongoing chat interactions with digital characters soon.

"I'm losing the memories I had with these bots," she said. "It's not fair."

After the company said it would begin time-limiting underage users' chats ahead of

the policy change, Olga attempted to rally fellow teens to resist the change in a post on Reddit: "HOW DO I USE IT FOR 2 HOURS AND HAVE TO WAIT A DAY? HELLO?"

Character.AI, one of the top makers of role-play and companion chatbots, implemented the daily two-hour limit in November, citing mental-health concerns. This week the company started cutting off teens completely.

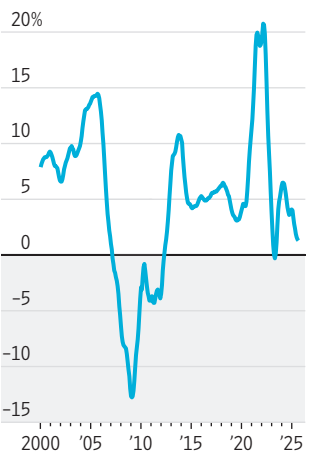
Character.AI's first version, launched in 2022, offered some of the earliest chatbots available to consumers. It quickly gained traction among people who wanted to role play with its customizable characters, netting the company about 20 million monthly users today.

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Growth Slows In Home Prices

U.S. home prices rose 1.3% in the 12 months through September, the weakest growth since mid-2023. **A2**

S&P Cotality Case-Shiller U.S. national home-price index, change from a year earlier



Source: St. Louis Fed